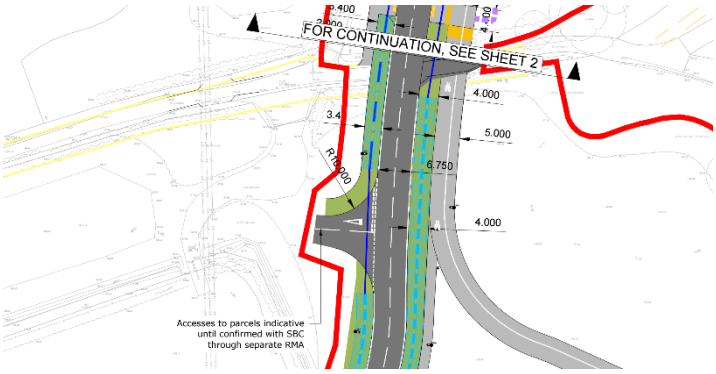
South Marston Parish Council

Response to S/RES/24/1020: Primary Street

17/3/2025

South Marston Parish Council comments as follows

We note that some of the relevant plans may not have been posted on the portal. We appear to be missing any update of 'General Arrangements Sheet 1' – the original of which is shown to the right. We have accessed the updated Sheets 2 to 5 for the comments below. This missing sheet is of some concern as:



- The area of existing flooding (see below) would be covered on this sheet at the point where the notation says 'FOR CONTINUATION SEE SHEET 2'
- This sheet shows the most complex of all the junctions with multiple new footways, cycleways and bridleways converging on the existing Morses Lane (bordered by faint yellow lines) and Bridleway 4, both of which carry existing vehicle traffic across the Primary Street. It does not show the route of the secondary road going north to parcel R1, apart from the T junction. There is no movement analysis to show how it will work in conjunction with its existing use by vehicles, pedestrians and horse-riders. <u>By not showing clearly the complexity of that junction, mistakes in its design may be made as it has implications for traffic priorities, signage, safe crossings/visibility, lighting locations, and drainage.</u>

Movement Analysis: We see the 5m wide cycleway/footpath adjacent to the full length of the Primary Street until it crosses Morses Lane still reduces at its western end to 3.5m to reach the new Thornhill Rd roundabout. Is the applicant still working on the premise that the cycle route to the A420 for all the South Marston housing expansion is via the 'Green Bridge over the railway line'? There are no arrangements for that route to be delivered over 3rd party land from the railway bridge to the A420.

Unless that is secured, the only possible safe cycle route to the A420 would be along the Primary Street to the Thornhill Rd junction, so **should this not be widened to 5m to allow safe passage of cyclists?**

Services Corridor

It is acknowledged that all proposals on utilities are still subject to agreement with suppliers.

Whilst the utilities are laid along the Primary Street with ducting underneath the roadside cycleways, the plans do not indicate the nature of the construction. **Does the ducting have appropriate access/inspection chambers for installation, routine maintenance and upgrading of utilities?** If not then the combined cycle/footpath will suffer being repeatedly dug up and patched which is unsatisfactory.

Design of Roadside Swales/gullies.

We welcome the detail on the cross-section design of how the north/west and west surface water flows will be drained under the Primary Street. The design itself, with piping and catchpits is acceptable. We conclude, though that because the application red line does not include the relevant open space designs, there are specific instances of the Primary Street 'under-flow' drainage where there is no indication of how the surface water, once under the road, will reach Basin A towards Old Vicarage Lane. In other locations, the means by which surface water flows under the Primary Street is not identified.

The catchment area table shows that parcel R1 will drain to Basin A. We have been shown Vistry plans identifying swale/ditch design to take the water flow as far as the Primary Street. We understand the water will flow into the existing north/south ditch reaching the Primary Street just west of the PROW crossing indicated in General Arrangements Sheet 2 (right). We assume this ditch will be culverted so water can reach the southern edge of the Primary Street.

At this point, the land slopes southwards towards the railway. The water cannot flow uphill via the Primary Street roadside filter verges. We do not understand how the notation on the plan is to be achieved given the contours of the land: '*Existing ditchcourse to be diverted east and to connect into existing overland flow route, subject to LLFA watercourse consent*'

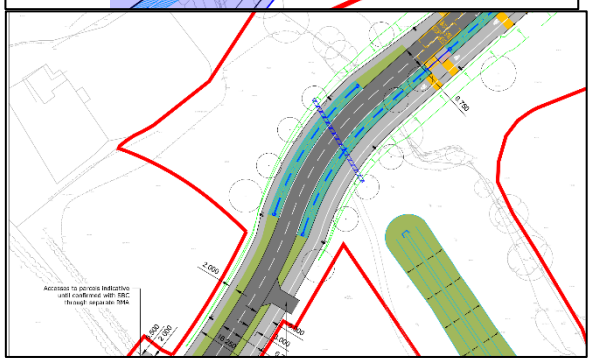
Our concern is that, just further west of this 'crossing', lies one of the areas most susceptible to flooding at the moment i.e. Morses Lane road access to South Marston Farm. **The applicant should be asked to explain how this water will be captured onsite and directed safely away from access roads and housing on third party land** which is the southern side of the red line in the diagram extract above.

Drainage of FP6 central area (R3,4,5)

We are happy to see the catchpit underflow at this location. Whereas we are aware that there are new swales planned for the southern boundary of R5, it would have been helpful to show how the surface water flow reaches the planned swales that will divert it towards Basin A.

Catchpit underflow location R6/R8

This is the Primary Street just north of Red House, with parcels R6 and R8 lying to the east of it. This is the line of the heaviest of the local surface water flow from north of the Leaze, under the Leaze culvert. The swale taking water away to the basin to the southwest does not start at the Primary Street itself, so we have to conclude that the pipe under the road will extend all the way into the main part of this swale.



We have discussed with Brookbanks their failure to take account of the surface water flow from the north. We were promised that, although the overall Surface Water Strategy was agreed, the appended note to the plan stated that additional swales/piping were required on the Bell Gardens field and area

between that and the Leaze, and these would be designed at a later date. We would assert that, given the visible impact of standing water throughout the winter to the north of the Primary Street route, **the capacity of pipes, catchpit and the swale must be sufficient to avoid flooding neighbouring properties**. It is worth noting that the existing property closest to this location (Red House) is the one which traditionally experiences regular internal flooding at present, as documented in the South Marston Flood Report produced in November 2023.

It would have been helpful to define these 'routes for surface water flow' rather than have to deduce them from local knowledge and hope that the capacity of the pipes is sufficient to safely direct flows into Basin A.

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